

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 705

By Carringer

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Costas "Gus" Brinias of Knoxville.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Costas "Gus" Brinias;
and

WHEREAS, Gus Brinias was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Kesari, Korinthia, Greece, on January 9, 1931, Mr. Brinias was the son of Dimitrios and Athanasia Brinias; he immigrated to Montreal, Canada, in the early 1950s, working on a farm for many years to support his family in Greece and eventually transitioning to work in the restaurant industry; and

WHEREAS, he and his brother, Frank, opened their first restaurant together in Montreal, operating it for many years; after he met his beloved companion Voula, the two were wed in 1966 and moved their family to Knoxville in the early 1970s to pursue the American Dream; and

WHEREAS, Gus Brinias worked tirelessly to provide a better life for his family, becoming a well-known restaurateur in Knoxville; he owned and operated Gus's Restaurant, located on Gay Street, from 1974 to 1988, as well as The Original Louis Drive-In Restaurant, located on Old Broadway, which he owned and operated until his retirement in 2005; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his passion for cooking, he enjoyed gardening and traveling; he was a devoted member of Saint George Greek Orthodox Church and volunteered his time and talents at the Greek Fest each year; and

WHEREAS, Gus Brinias was deeply devoted to his family; he loved spending time with his wife and children and spoiling his grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his loving wife of fifty-nine years, Voula Andriopoulos Brinias; son, Jimmy (Tammy) Brinias; daughter, Cathy (Bryan) Johnson; grandchildren, Maria Brinias, Eleni Brinias, Dean Johnson, Linzy Johnson; and Michael (Claire) Adams; great-grandchildren, Aidan Adams and Caroline Adams; special nephew, Dr. Anthony Captain; and several godchildren, nieces, and nephews; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his brothers, Vlasi Brinias and Frank Brinias, and sister, Vivian Captain; and

WHEREAS, Gus Brinias leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Costas "Gus" Brinias, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction. We extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Brinias.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.